

Buzz complaints

A class action complaint was filed in the San Jose federal court accusing Google Buzz of breaking law by sharing data without users consent

Google Aardvark?

Google to acquire a social search engine Aardvark which was a startup by former Google employees indulging in social media search

contrast ratio. There is a fair bit of detail to the textures in Crysis, although we'd like a little more highlighting and some more crispness to the colour. Surprisingly, we noticed text on the Windows desktop seemed to look a little blurry with true type font enabled. BenQ's G2220HD had a really good contrast and the brightness level was also pretty good. Owing to this, we found it to be a good performer in movies — very minor banding in underwater scenes with the colour blue and this could be a result of the non-native 8-bit panel as well, which is a theoretical limit to its colour-producing ability. Crysis looked good — good highlights and detailing. Foliage looked very crisp and vibrant. It also did well in DisplayMate, except for the 256-shade intensity test.

Trophy time

The BenQ G2220HD trounced the others in this roundup and by no small margin. Such as it stands, mentioning the others in this award space makes no sense. It wins our Digit Best Buy award for its great performance at a very competitive price of Rs. 9,200 — the cheapest in this category. A classic example of less being more.

20-inches:

Endangered species or survival story?

There was a time when we predicted 20-inch monitors would be history. The tenacious things proved us wrong. And you can't blame us, for 22-inch monitors were offering similar prices and an identical screen resolution. It seems 20-inches have carved their own niche.



Viewsonic VX2233wm

They sport a resolution of 1600 x 900 pixels these days, just below the 1920 x 1080 that 22-inch LCDs ship with. This makes them less of competitors and more like a cheaper option.

The Fujitsu L20T-1 ECO was the sole piece from this brand. Although it's well built, the stand is tacky and feels cheap with quite a bit of flex. The menu buttons on the bottom but the OSD is good and tells you where the button will be. The Acer H203H has a small stand though the base is pretty solid and heavy owing to thick plastics. The tilt mechanism is hard. Sadly, a glossy on the screen makes it reflective. The OSD buttons are well laid out although on the side. The menu system is a little weird since you have to press the button corresponding to the on screen display and this usually works well when the buttons are right next to the screen, not on the side of it — usability isn't intuitive. Power button looks neat with a circular white backlight that isn't intrusive.

Samsung's B2030 is similar to its larger sibling, though the stand feels solid. Samsung doesn't care much for slim bezels and the B2030 doesn't break the mould. ASUS' VH202D too shares a similar look to its larger

sibling, though it is actually tackier.

Performance

The Fujitsu L20T-1 ECO is aggressive with its power saving mode, thereby living up to the emphasis on the word in its name. With eco mode on, the brightness falls to 141.8 lumens; with eco mode off it rises to a respectable 245.3 lumens. Cyan on green is really bad, ditto magenta on red and yellow on white also problematic — poor performance in the reverse text tests. In the 16-shade intensity test, the two highest intensities of red nearly blend — besides

intensity shades, but it's the lower intensity ones that lose out on detail. Greys tend to merge. In Crysis the foliage look crisp — better than the Fujitsu L20T-1 ECO and with great detailing. However, highlights are still not as good as we'd like.

For the Samsung B2030, cyan on green, green on cyan, yellow on white, white on yellow all look bad. Brighter intensities of red tend to look similar with less variation. Movies have good detail and highlighting, there is less detail in darker scenes, though the contrast ratio is good and so is the blackness level of this monitor — in fact the latter specification

was the best among all the monitors at 0.15 (the BenQ G922HDL was the only other monitor with this blackness level) — pretty good for a TN panel. Colours are vivid, yet not over rich, the one exception being red, which looks overdone at times. In Crysis, the delay in backlight adjusting is a problem and the game seems a little too dark on 50 per

cent brightness and contrast. The ASUS VH202D manages to clear the movie and game tests but Display Mate was harsh with poor results in the reverse text and shade intensity tests.

And the winners are

Acer's H203H sweeps up our Best Buy award. Priced at Rs. 7,250 it's ideal for someone looking to buy a good monitor for their desktop usage and would serve well for movies too. The Fujitsu L20T-1 ECO would be our second option, but really as long as you can get your hands on the Acer, we



Acer H203H

this we also ran into the usual gamut of problems for our movie tests — banding, loss of detail in darker scenes, but this wasn't as bad as some of the other panels. Crysis looked good, surprisingly so, and the highlighting was pretty nice. The Acer H203H has a really good whiteness level. White on yellow is a problem in the reverse text tests. Banding noticeable with blue, in fact slight compression with the colour blue was also noticeable in some scenes. Movies look good with the extra brightness lending some detail higher